

3.2 Video Encoders

Encoding is the process of changing compression formats of the video stream. The most popular forms of video data available on the net are DivX, XviD, WMV, MOV. Unless you have a standalone player that supports these formats or intend to watch the movie on your PC, you need to encode these files into the VCD or DVD format.

The reverse process would be necessitated to save storage space. A DVD video would take upto 3.5 GB of space, while the same can be compressed to a 700 MB XviD/DivX file with minimal loss in quality.

If you are wondering, what are the minimum specs required to encode video; the best answer is, it depends on your patience. The faster the system, the less you have to wait for the process to complete. Also the more you intend to compress a video the longer the process will take.

3.2.1 Media Coder

Media Coder (MC) is a very capable but difficult to handle encoder. This is a front end that uses other Open Source video tools like FFmpeg and Mplayer in the background. Since it is in its infancy, the bugs have to be forgiven. The latest version (0.5) is buggier than older ones like 0.3.9 (at least in our case). This review refers to the latter.

Use: Convert MPEG2/MPEG1/AVI (DivX,Xvid)/3GP/MOV/Real Audio/etc., to MPEG2/MPEG/AVI (DivX)/etc.

Platforms: Windows

Home Page: mediacoder.sourceforge.net

Features

No other encoder boasts of such a range of encoding capabilities as MC. MC can convert into formats used in portable viewers like PSP, Mobile Phones, etc.